

August 2026

Dear Clifford R,

I've worked in and around Lafayette for a long time, and a farmhouse-style home on a park-like half-acre with mature oaks and genuine privacy is the kind of property that stops me mid-scroll. The combination of that setting, the open floor plan, and the quality of the updates at 3348 Walnut Lane made it clear to me this was something worth paying close attention to. When the listing came off the market after 69 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out, because I don't think that outcome reflects the property.

Sixty-nine days is long enough for a home this well-positioned to tell us something. At \$904 per square foot, this listing sat at the upper end of the Lafayette premium range, and that's a number that requires a specific buyer who has been shown exactly why it's right. The peaceful cul-de-sac, the indoor-outdoor connection to those gardens and decks, the oak canopy and trail access, these are the things that justify the number. But if the marketing didn't actively build that case for the buyers who were in the market, the price felt exposed rather than supported. That's a strategy gap, not a property problem.

I've put together a short analysis of what I think happened and how I'd approach this differently. It covers the three friction points I see in the listing history, a positioning comparison against current Lafayette benchmarks, and a relaunch framework built around the specific assets this home actually has. Nothing in here is a generic playbook.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside. If you're not, I'd welcome a short conversation. No pressure, no pitch, just a chance to walk you through what I've found.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a stylized flourish extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

3348 Walnut Ln

Lafayette, CA 94549

4.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,208 Sq Ft · Lafayette

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 3348 Walnut Ln

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Fully Reimagined Farmhouse on a Half-Acre Cul-de-Sac Lot - and a Listing That Never Finished the Story

3348 Walnut Lane has the kind of combination that Lafayette buyers search hard to find: a high-quality remodel with a genuine open floor plan, four bedrooms on a 21,340-square-foot park-like lot with mature oaks and real privacy, in a location that puts Las Trampas Swim Club, the Lafayette-Orinda Trail, and top-rated schools within a short walk. The chef's kitchen with its breakfast bar, the custom built-ins, the wood-burning fireplace, the multiple access points to the gardens and deck - these are the details that buyers in this price range are specifically looking for when they've decided not to compromise.

The listing history doesn't match those fundamentals. At \$904 per square foot, the home was priced in the upper tier of the Lafayette premium range, and 69 days on market without a sale tells us the marketing never fully built the case that justified that number. A buyer at \$1,995,000 needs to feel the value before they schedule a showing, not after. The setting, the privacy, the outdoor living - these are visual assets that standard MLS photography and a text description rarely capture at the level that moves a qualified buyer from interest to action. The strategy ran out of runway before it found its audience.

\$1,995,000

List Price

\$904/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for this home needs to do one thing well: make the setting, the quality, and the lifestyle legible to buyers who are shopping online before they ever call an agent. This property has the assets to support its price. The next campaign needs to show them.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 69 Days and a Buyer Who Never Got the Visual

After 69 days on the market, buyer psychology had already shifted from curiosity to skepticism. Past the 45-day mark, the question changes from 'Is this a good home?' to 'What's wrong with it?' - and that stigma wasn't earned by 3348 Walnut Lane, it was created by a distribution strategy that ran out of ideas. A half-acre cul-de-sac lot with mature oaks and a genuine park-like setting is the kind of asset that photographs and aerial footage can communicate in seconds. Without that, buyers comparing listings online moved on before they understood what the lot actually felt like. The right buyer was likely out there during those 69 days. The listing just never reached them in a way that made them stop.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour captures the lot position, the oak canopy, and the cul-de-sac setting from the air - giving buyers the spatial context that ground photography and satellite thumbnails simply can't deliver.

Friction #2: A \$904/Sqft Price With No Story Behind It

At \$904 per square foot, this home sat at the top of the Lafayette premium tier. That number is defensible - the lot size, the quality of the remodel, the farmhouse character, and the location genuinely support it. But a buyer comparing this against other Lafayette listings at similar price points needs to understand specifically what they're getting here that they can't find elsewhere. The listing described the features. It didn't build the argument for the price. When buyers can't answer that question themselves, they move on or they offer less. The perceived value gap wasn't a pricing error - it was a marketing gap that left a well-priced home vulnerable to doubt.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement positions this home with an enhanced listing page and premium narrative placement - so buyers see the case for the number before they compare it to anything else.

Friction #3: Stale Listing, No Pivot

The listing was withdrawn after 69 days without a visible change in strategy - no media rebuild, no repositioning, no new approach. When a listing isn't working past the 45-day mark, more time on the same path doesn't rebuild buyer interest, it deepens the perception that something is wrong. A home like this, with genuine premium assets and no structural issues to explain the outcome, needed a different campaign, not just more calendar days. Passive relisting resets the clock but doesn't reset the narrative. The home deserved a real second chapter.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com offers a clean starting point - qualified Bay Area buyers who haven't seen the prior listing receive the home fresh, without the days-on-market counter working against it.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	3348 Walnut Ln	Lafayette Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$904/sqft	Premium tier: \$850–\$920/sqft
Lot / Setting	21,340 sqft park-like cul-de-sac lot with mature oaks and garden patios	Typical Lafayette lot: 8,000–12,000 sqft
Architectural Character	Reimagined farmhouse style with high-quality remodel and open floor plan	Standard 1960s–70s ranch or split-level, often partially updated
Premium Features	Chef's kitchen with breakfast bar, custom built-ins, wood-burning fireplace, multiple indoor-outdoor access points to gardens and deck	Standard floor plan, functional kitchen, single outdoor access point
HOA	None	None typical for Lafayette single-family

The verdict: At \$904/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$850-\$920/sqft, this home sits near the upper end of that range. At \$904 per square foot, this home sits near the high end of the Lafayette premium tier, and the lot size, remodel quality, and cul-de-sac setting fully justify the position. The challenge wasn't the number - it was that the marketing didn't arm buyers with the visual and narrative evidence to feel confident at that price before scheduling a showing. A relaunch that leads with the lot, the setting, and the quality of the updates changes that dynamic.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Lead With the Half-Acre, Not the Floor Plan

Most buyers searching in this price range have already toured their share of updated kitchens. What they can't find easily is 21,340 square feet of park-like privacy on a cul-de-sac, within walking distance of trails and top-rated schools. That lot is the headline, and it needs to be the first thing a buyer experiences - from the air, from the garden, from the deck. BrightWork's Sky Tour and cinematic photography rebuild that story from the ground up, so buyers arrive at the floor plan already sold on the setting.

Pillar II - Rebuild the Narrative Before It Hits Zillow

The \$1,995,000 ask is a number that requires preparation, not just placement. Before this home relists publicly, the case for the price needs to be built into every element of the campaign - the listing description, the visual sequence, the data framing, the portal presentation. BrightWork's 3D Matterport tour lets serious buyers walk every room from anywhere, reducing wasted showings and increasing the quality of the interest that actually comes through the door. Buyers who've already experienced the home online show up ready to make decisions.

Pillar III - Find the Buyer Who Was Never Reached

The buyer for this home is likely a Lafayette-focused professional or family that's been circling Lamorinda from San Francisco or Oakland, shopping online before committing to a weekend of showings. They weren't necessarily inactive during those 69 days - they just weren't being reached by a standard MLS distribution. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns put this home in front of Bay Area buyers who are actively researching Lafayette before they've found what they're looking for, turning passive searchers into scheduled showings.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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